Vedant Vohra

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Education

University of California, San Diego — San Diego, CA
Ph.D., Economics — 2021–Present

Pomona College — Claremont, CA
B.A., Mathematics and Economics — 2015–2019

Research Areas

Econometrics; Public Economics

References

Graham Elliott (Co-chair)
Sir Clive Granger Professor of Econometrics
Department of Economics
University of California San Diego
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Kaspar Wuthrich (Co-chair)
Associate Professor
Department of Economics
University of Michigan
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Itzik Fadlon
Associate Professor
Department of Economics
University of California San Diego
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Craig McIntosh
Professor of Economics
School of Global Policy and Strategy
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Placement Director: Prashant Bharadwaj (prbharadwaj@ucsd.edu)
Placement Coordinator: Andrew Flores (econ-jobmarket@ucsd.edu)

Job Market Paper

1. Identification Under Universal Policy Exposure

Abstract: Many important policy reforms have two key features. First, all units are exposed to the reform at the same time. Second, the reform alters the incentives to take up an already available treatment. How can we leverage such a policy change to identify treatment effects, in the absence of an unexposed comparison group? While there is no cross-sectional variation in the timing of the reform, units differ in how their treatment take-up responds to the reform. To leverage this variation for identification, I extend the local average treatment effect (LATE) framework to a panel setting where a unit's latent compliance type, defined by comparing potential treatment choices with and without the policy in each period, can change over time. I establish that there are two routes to point identify the LATE under parallel trends. The first approach restricts the mechanisms governing selection into treatment, ruling out specific transitions in compliance types over time. The second restricts heterogeneity in treatment effects across latent compliance types. To accommodate richer selection mechanisms and unobserved effect heterogeneity, I develop a marginal treatment effects approach that delivers sharp bounds on causal parameters of interest under economically motivated shape restrictions. Applying the framework to Medicare Part D, I estimate that prescription-drug coverage improved medication access and reduced labor supply among individuals induced to obtain it by the reform.

Publications

2. Inference for Welfare Metrics
Journal of Public Economics (2026)

3. Identifying the Cumulative Causal Effect of a Non-Binary Treatment from a Binary Instrument
Vedant Vohra (lead author) and Jacob Goldin
Accepted, Review of Economics and Statistics

4. The Claiming of Children on U.S. Tax Returns
Geoffrey Gee, Jacob Goldin, Joseph Gray-Hancuch, Ithai Lurie, and Vedant Vohra
National Tax Journal (2026)

Working Papers

5. Enhancing Revenue Collection Capacity through Automation: Evidence from a VAT
Bhanu Gupta, Tejaswi Velayudhan, Vedant Vohra, and Ankur Garg
Conditionally Accepted, American Economic Review: Insights

6. The Racial Penalty in Job Ladder Transitions
Itzik Fadlon, Briana Sullivan, and Vedant Vohra
NBER Working Paper 34058

Work in Progress

7. Testing Whether the Product of Two Parameters is Zero
Graham Elliott and Vedant Vohra

8. Normalizing and Pooling Rank-based Regression Discontinuity Designs
Matias Cattaneo, Gordon Dahl, Aibo Gong, Xinwei Ma, and Vedant Vohra

Employment

Microsoft | Redmond, WA — 2025
Research Intern, Office of the Chief Economist

Stanford University | Palo Alto, CA — 2019–2021
Research Fellow

Teaching Experience

University of California, San Diego | San Diego, CA — 2021–Present
ECON 220A: Econometrics I (Graduate Core)
GPCO 468: Evaluating Technological Innovations (M.A. Capstone Course, Public Policy School)
ECON 120A: Econometrics I (Undergraduate)
ECON 5: Data Analysis for Social Science (Undergraduate)

Workshops and Presentations (*Scheduled)

Pomona College, Department of Economics*	2026
Rutgers University, Department of Food, Agricultural and Resource Economics	2026
Midwest Econometrics Group Annual Meeting	2026
National Tax Association (NTA) 118th Annual Conference on Taxation	2025
Southern California Conference in Applied Microeconomics (SoCCAM)	2025
Machine Learning in Economics Summer School, Chicago Booth	2022
Office of Tax Analysis Research Conference, U.S. Department of the Treasury	2020

Grants

Russell Sage Foundation (co-PI with Itzik Fadlon, Briana Sullivan), *$108,000*	2024
UCSD GPSA Summer Travel and Research Grant, *$400*	2025
UCSD Economics Summer Travel and Research Grant, *$400 × 2*	2023, 2025
UCSD Black Studies Project Research Grant, *$2,000*	2023
UCSD Program of Indian Economy Summer Research Grant, *$5,000 × 2*	2022-23

Honors and Awards

Walter Heller Memorial Prize (Best 3rd Year Paper), UCSD	2023–2024
Best Graduate Student Research Seminar Presentation, UCSD	2023–2024
Zhao Family Fellowship for Most Promising Econometrics Research, UCSD	2024
Distinction for Senior Thesis in Economics, Pomona College	2019
Senior Service Award for Leadership, Pomona College	2019
College Scholar Distinction, Pomona College	2016, 2017

SKILLS **Languages**: English, Hindi
Programming: `Stata`, `R`, `Python`, LaTeX, `MATLAB`

REFEREE SERVICE *Journal of Econometrics, Economic Development and Cultural Change, PLOS One*

CITIZENSHIP U.S. Permanent Resident (Indian Citizen)